

🌟 Accion Innovation Summit 2026 Live Streaming-20260226_124600UTC-Meeting Recording

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Hello everyone, can we please settle down? We're starting starting the event.

Kindly settle down, please. I know it's a lot of fun to connect with all the people around here, but please, please settle down now. We want to start the event.

Thank you, guys. Well, good evening, everybody. My name is Praveen. For many of you who don't know me, I joined Axion about eight months ago as the Chief Marketing Officer. It's been an absolutely brilliant ride so far, and Kinnage gave me the honor to open Summit this year. So it's it's a blessing.

Of sorts. And wow, thank you all for making it from different parts of the country and overseas. I know some of you had challenges in terms of, you know, having to reschedule flights and there were some weather issues in the northeastern part of the United States. But thank you all for making it.

And it's amazing to see each and everyone of you. So once again, welcome to Accion Labs Innovation Summit 2026.

And for a brief moment, take a moment for yourselves and look around you. What do we have in the room? We have engineers, architects, investors who will be coming and joining us shortly. Technologists, tech leaders, founders, entrepreneurs.

And most importantly, me, yeah.

OK, so the next 2 1/2 days, which are going to be, which are going to be pretty power-packed with, you know, sessions, panels, discussions, demos and obviously conversations, networking opportunities and a lot a lot of fun during the evenings. So the daytime is all work.

And in the evening we have, you know, I'm gonna rule to party hard and.

The best part about all of this is all of you, you know, get to have front row seats to what we believe is the future of innovation and enjoy it, soak it all in. And without much further ado, I have a few housekeeping things to take care of, so.

Let's go. So venue information so you know where you are. Registration desk. Most of you are registered. Those of you who have not, you can go to the atrium and pick up your badges. I believe some of you haven't received your badges, so if you have not, just please go there.

Dining and breaks. All lunches and dinners will be behind you guys in the ballroom foyer area, except for, I would say, dinner on the 27th, which is tomorrow night restrooms.

Are on the backside of the atrium on either side. On one side is the men's room. On the other side of the atrium is the women's room. Emergency exits are right behind you. So in case of an emergency, just walk out calmly. Don't run, yeah.

Some housekeeping stuff. Always keep your phones on silent and please return on time after the breaks so that you know we can run the entire summit on schedule and on time. Yeah, and please, you know, display your badges very, very proudly. It's your personal brand, your professional brand.

And it stands testimony to the fact that you know you're here for a very, very important phase of Accion's annual journey, which is the Innovation Summit.

Obviously speakers are the all important people who run the show, so please be very respectful of their time and please, you know, come back whenever you are done with your break time and mind the cameras, so essentially.

We are actually shooting the entire summit. We're going to be recording it for internal purposes and I'll come to that.

Clickers working. Yeah, Wi-Fi access. Some of you have asked whether, you know, we have dedicated Wi-Fi access and a dedicated network for summit. The answer is no. Each of you are guests at the hotel and each of you would have activated your respective Wi-Fi on your devices. The conference, like I said, will be recorded for internal purposes only.

In case you need to kind of record anything, you need to kind of kind of tag us for consent. You're welcome to share whatever you see and record here on your social media personal handles only. And yes, like I said, the recording.

Policy is something that we've covered already. I can't really read what I've written, so pardon me, I might like. I actually thought I'm going to be right in the middle, but we kind of changed the stage orientation. Safety and emergency procedures of existed evacuation are clearly marked at the back. We have some first aid.

The assembly point in case of an emergency will be to kind of walk out of the atrium and make a left and head towards the parking lot. And in case of a fire alarm, you know, the same, you know, evacuation procedures, you know, pretty much come to play.

So that's pretty much it, I guess. So let's get started. And it's my absolute privilege to invite on stage our CEO, Kinesh Doshi, to kick things off. Welcome, ladies and

gentlemen, give it up to Kinesh Doshi.

Thank you. Thank you. Thanks, Praveen. Welcome everyone. As Praveen said, you guys have come from far and wide, a lot of international travelers who actually came in early morning today.

Wow. OK, who left early morning and came here for the summit? Lot of you. Some people seem to be missing. Are they outside?

A lot of people came for the summit, they left from Bangalore, Pune, wherever, and then came this afternoon. So again, I think we should lock all those doors so that these guys can't get out because they're probably tired.

No, we're not going to do that. Thank you again for coming, taking more than three days of your time to come to the Axion Innovation Summit. All the employees, all our leaders, all our customers.

A big welcome to you and our investors. So thank you again. So let me start set the context for this presentation. Now this is a summit about innovators, about technologists. So I'll be the last non-technical guy speaking here, but I hope I can keep your attention.

Attention for the next 4550 minutes. What I'm going to do is I'm going to actually I do this each year. I give a high level company update to all the leaders of Accion and of course clients get to experience that also what the Accion.

Journey has been this year. I will also talk a little bit about our innovation, our customers.

And their impact that they make and each year I pick up a few customers just to kind of give all of us a glimpse because sometimes you are in your project and you really don't know what Accion is doing or what other customers we work with. So it will be great for me to kind of really at least show you some.

Some of the clients that we work with and the impact that they make. Then I'm going to actually this year, as many of you know, we are celebrating 15th year of Axion Labs. So thank you.

15 years ago, on a cold morning in February of 2011 in Pittsburgh, PA, we started this company. So I want to tell you what the journey has been and more than the journey. I want to tell you what we learned along the way, because that's important, right? So I would cover some of those learnings as well as we go through this. So let's get started.

First of all, thank you again. A lot of clients, a lot of guests have come to this summit. You know I think 40 or so customers are here and we're going to actually do a

customer breakfast also on Saturday morning. So hopefully we'll we'll get some time, you guys will get some time together to.

Socialize. We have analysts there from ISG as well as our investors, TA associates. So welcome to everyone and welcome to all the employees because they work so hard all through the year and they get that one day. I think you're probably away from work on Friday, so.

So thank you for doing that.

So why Innovation Summit? I want to 1st talk about what it is not and I I do this all the time because of the concept of Innovation Summit. So we started Innovation Summit almost a couple years into founding of the company and it started as a leadership summit and then we said well we should actually discuss innovation we. Separated out our leadership summit on a different part of the year.

So our summit is not a business planning event because I've been to many of the summits where they are actually trying to talk about the business, the revenue and the growth.

PM Prachi Mishra 12:38

All of them.

AU Accion University 12:41

This is not a sales conference. This is also not a leadership summit because like I said, we do a separate leadership summit. Most of we come to that summit, at least from the Accion side. So we do a delivery excellence summit that happens during Thanksgiving. So there are different other platforms. So it's none of those. We're not going to talk about delivery excellence.

Right. Because that's a different platform we do. We're not going to launch any new service offerings. This is not a motivational retreat. I always tell people I'm not a chief motivator. I'm the chief instigator, right? So I push you. So it's not a motivational retreat and it is. So we haven't invited Andre Agassi.

We haven't invited Shahrukh Khan. We haven't invited Reed Witherspoon, so we couldn't afford them first of all. But if we did, this is a kind of a different summit. So this is. So it's not an entertainment event, but as.

Many of you who have attended the summit, they know that there is an entertainment element also at the summit, but that's not what the focus is. So what is the focus of the summit? The focus of the summit is purely learning.

And idea exchange. It's a place where technologists network with each other. We do not like web scrape ideas. We do not like content that is already, you know, published. We want to create opinions. We want to create insights. We want to create new thoughts.

A new idea generation, and this is very important. I've said this many times and you won't believe how much of control I personally do about this. And Ash is amazing at that, our CTO, and he'll probably speak. I think he's right after me. But the point is we don't want to talk about what some.

Vague idea on some graph. We want to talk about something that is actionable on Monday morning, not something that is three years out, four years out. And I think last year I talked about it. Last year's summit's focus was AI.

And so I I panicked. I want to tell you in 2025 when we did the summit and I called Ash saying, Ash, this is something futuristic and I don't want to talk about anything that is not a Monday morning idea. And he says, Kinesh, you have no idea. This is the Monday morning idea.

This is exactly the world is going in that direction. And of course I learned my lesson from that and last year's summit was amazing. And this year, as you can see, I think the team is a lot more AI focused, but we'll talk about everything.

So let's talk about company Accion update quickly. I'll just give you a quick update on 2025. I got back on the growth journey. The macro environment has been quite tough as we all know our customers.

Have challenges, but this year we grew, you know, I think this year and what I will talk about 26 in a minute, but we onboarded 20 plus new clients by the way, pretty much all new clients.

Are coming up under our AI first platform LED approach which is just amazing to see that all the customers you know they want you to use AI, they want to apply AI and they want they're in excited about our platforms and technologies that that we bring. This is something I talked about last year to at least a lot of our employees remember that that we want to move towards more strategic partnership and not tactical partnerships. So you won't believe we actually in some ways knowingly, knowingly, knowingly, unknowingly with plan unplanned, we actually.

Let go about \$8 million of business last year and that's for a company to make that decision to let go that kind of business and refocus all our energies on customers where we have strategic partnership or we can add value.

To that partnership.

As you think about strategic partners, partnerships, a very important aspect of that is engagement management. That means providing the customers access to everything that Axion has. And so we expanded our engagement management team this year. We also added three new strategy and tech advisory leaders and we'll see. I'll probably have the names of those also, so we'll talk about that. But that has been a great addition to our AI first mindset because they brought a lot of amazing experience to Axion Labs.

This year we had started a CAB customer Advisory Board a couple years post COVID, but this year we started that again and several of our Advisory Board members are actually here today. So thank you for joining us. And so with 10 of our key clients, we started that it's been a.

Fantastic, fantastic journey with them to hear the perspective of a customer. How should Accion invest its time, resources and strategic energy? We established A partnership organization that we didn't have.

We had some of it, but we kind of consolidated that under Nitin and that business has grown 31% this year. So thanks to all the work that Nitin and his team has done. We established actually a new group this year. It's called Advanced Technology Group. So this is outside of you can call it another COE that we established this year and our Advanced Technology Group's charter is to work on technologies that none of our customers are using.

Today, so the technologies of the future and it's very young group, it's a small group, but I think we'll be continuing to invest. And so our idea is we tell them you don't have to produce revenue, you don't have to produce actual project, you basically create competency in technologies that of the future so.

Again, Shahid here, he's leading that. So if anyone wants to contribute to the ATG group, Advanced Technology Group, please talk to him and he has a bunch of projects that he's working on.

This year we so we had lots of IP and tool development projects across Accion which were scattered across different programs. We consolidated that everything under our CIO. So here CIO is both Chief Information Officer as well as Chief Innovation Officer. He's not here today Ashish.

Is not.

Hopefully you guys, most of the employees of course already know him, but I think he's been an incredible force. He's bringing all our programs together, making sure IP makes the impact and it just doesn't. So that's for most of the people you know,

sometimes IP is not used. You invest, you build it, but no one comes.

To use it. So I think he's been focused on that. We have of course our learning team, Karthick and his entire team has been hyper focused on AI learning. So we've had made some significant progress on that.

2000 plus of the engineers of Accion Labs now are trained on different aspects of AI. We also acquired in 2025 a fantastic set up a partnership and built out Diamanti's. Global Delivery Center in Pune and Amandeep is here heading their engineering organization. So it's been a it's been a great partnership that has really expanded our capability and Kubernetes and and other containerization technologies.

We also acquired Netserf. It's a tech services business you know between US and India and we acquired more than 100 employees through Netserf acquisition, which has been a great addition to the team and several Netserf people are here.

Today they brought a lot of insurance domain expertise also along with that and I know some some of our clients operate in insurance space. So we'd love for you to see what the Netserv team brings. So that's 2025 in a nutshell.

Hello. And it's been, it's been an action-packed year. Oh yeah, I have one more. Yes. So there has been incredible uplift in our brand, thanks to Praveen, you know, so he's done a great job of.

Reworking our websites, our brand presentation, our office look and feel and so on, really trying to integrate 1 Accion brand across all our offices. So it's just a fantastic work done and and as you go to our offices, if some of the clients are going to visit, they will experience that.

Over there, we have had a lot of leaders join. Raise your hand if you join in 2025 and part of 26. Sorry to bother you. Is it too close? Its too far.

Can you say something? I can't hear myself, so OK, can you try that?

Hello, can you guys hear me? Is that better all the way in the back?

OK. Thank you for raising your hands. OK, wonderful. So we've had, thanks Ash, we've had great new additions to the Accion team. We have Emanuel. He took over our Central and Eastern Europe.

Leadership. He's done an incredible job. He's been just almost amalgamated himself into Accion as soon as he arrived. So great job. Sanjay has joined as our APAC CTO. Veera Reddy joined us as Chief People Officer.

If you guys are here in the room, why don't you just stand up? Rise, please. Bharat, Rahul, Mayank, some great leaders have actually joined us. Sam, Raja and Mukund and Sridhar, they all came to Accion through the Nextserve acquisition.

Thank you and.

Surenda joined us as senior engagement manager. Gagan joined. And again, I apologize, I probably missed some of the great leaders that have joined this year. It was just off the top of my mind. I put all the people that I knew. So thank you very much. So again, an organization is all about its leaders and I think having these leaders join.

And become part of our journey and our culture is hugely valued. And I always say that new leaders need to feel comfortable when they join. So I think they're here after a year, so I hope they're feeling good. OK, so let's talk about.

26 for 26, I think one of the complaints I've received from our customers is they don't know what we do. So we want to give them access to our capabilities and rethink how we engage with our customers on our capability framework because we.

Do one. Once CEO is engaged with the customer, they think that's what our capability is, right? We have about 40 CEOs. So how we want to make sure that we have to rethink how we do that and there's active discussion. We've actually created a strategy council and a lot of council members are over here and of course we're getting inputs from our customer advisory.

Or also, I think we'll continue to work on that.

As I said, our IP strategy, we have to increase the utilization and usage of our IP. So I think there's a lot of effort going on between Ash and Ashish around that we have to create. So we see a huge opportunity in legacy modernization space and we also think.

That we have a head start in using Gen. AI to do legacy modernization and we have a lot of customer stories. So we want to just double down on legacy modernization and take that to our to the market. Some of our our technologies are currently hyperscaler independent.

And which is great, but also that means you don't get the momentum through our partnership with hyperscalers, which is AWS and Microsoft Azure and so on. So we want to take our IP and kind of customize it for specific hyperscalers. So there's effort going on on that.

We want to continue to promote efficiency focused offerings because right now customers are looking for efficiency. They are looking for and so there are a lot of you know vendor consolidation, security, OPS, managed services, first services, SDLC transformation, these are all.

Different aspects of optimizing or efficiency building. So we want to take that those

service offerings. We want to continue to invest. We were not analyst aware as an organization. We didn't spend much time on our resources on that.

So not many people know us, not many people. Axion Labs is not known by too many people in our customer market. So we want to engage and I think Gartner and ISG both we have started engaging this year. We want to promote our.

Are non India, non-us development centers. That means our CE and LATAM delivery centers. Our LATAM team, Mexico team couldn't come because of the unrest in in LATAM. But like I said, Emanuel is here from CE. So I think please spend some time with him and learn about that. By the way, I just want to say make one.

Comment here that look to your left, look to your right. If the person that is sitting next to you, you already know you're on the wrong table.

OK, you need to go on a table that people you do not know because this is a networking event and we need to learn about each other and especially because employees particularly have come from different cities. So just look around and say, OK, I want to go on that table because I don't know anyone over there.

OK, please do that.

We want to deepen our partnership with, you know, and as I mentioned, we have set up the partnership organization and Nitin is working really hard on that.

Ash will be talking about this. He spoke about this in the last summit called Semantic Engineering and the philosophy of semantic engineering. We want to implement that in more and more of our programs and even if that means reduction in our headcount, reduction in our revenue. But I think that's the good thing for efficiency and I think really keeps.

Gives more and more benefit to our customers.

We have built out the governance programs which we call our AVBPVB. I think we might be talking about that. I think we want to roll that out to more customers. We want to our current delivery methodology is not fully mapped to ISO or CMMI or other standard frameworks. So we want to do that. There's an effort going on.

On that right now, this is really my favorite. I always have said that younger leaders should get opportunity to grow in the organization and I think that's our talent team's priority is to actually look for young leaders.

And then give them a path to growth. So how many are the first time invitees to the Innovation Summit from Axion Labs? OK, awesome, awesome. Welcome, welcome.

So I think we want to get more and more leaders involved, young leaders involved and.

Provide them path to growth. So that's kind of the priority, strategic priority for the year and we'll be working on this more. I want to just quickly now show you some of the impactful stories. We have Humanitix leaders here. I think this is just a great story what Humanitix has been doing.

For many, many years, what, 70 years or 75 years is to build out technology for crash testing, which is used not only in cars but used in other automobiles, military equipments and aircrafts and so on. And I think we're very excited about. So again, I just want to.

I want to make you think, particularly Accion employees, when you're writing that Java code, when you're writing that Python code, you are touching so many human lives, directly or indirectly. I do believe that we touch about at least half a billion human lives.

Through the work we do and I think you can add that up the type of work our customers do. We have a significant partnership with LabCorp. We're actually working on the digital twin and AI programs and it's the one of the largest provider of diagnostic testing and drug discovery services. They are accelerating drug discovery.

And again, there are other smarter people here in the room that can talk about the work we are doing here. I was just excited about Dollar Energy Fund. Also, it's a nonprofit that actually helps and we have a lot of nonprofits.

In our customer portfolio, which gives me a lot of pride because when you work along with nonprofits, in some ways you're partner in their own impact and their purpose. So it's a great, great organization that actually helps people in need, you know, get grants for.

Energy Neighborly software, another fantastic platform. This platform helps government organizations disperse funds for specific programs. Again, it brings the money to communities that need and provides the entire platform and infrastructure to monitor.

Provide compliance and reports and so on. So you can see \$13 billion of grant money has been distributed by Naveli Software Parentpay. We have Parentpay also in the room and an organization.

That is probably the largest school platform, education, tech platform in the UK and we're working on their legacy modernization work. But just see the impact, I mean how many children that we're touching through them, American Nursing Association, ANA.

And again, Keely, she's here and very thankful for them to join us. So what we're doing with them is we're again helping in their own digital transformation journey.

But look at the impact they make, right, 5 million plus nursing professionals.

I know in many ways that work we do touches all these people, help them in their certifications and so on.

Builders first source, you know another customer actually we started working them in 2025, a large supplier of building products and construction services, you know again very large I think publicly traded business.

And you know they are heavily investing in digital technology. We have I think here from from Builder First Source. So really excited about this partnership. WSR

Insurance fantastic again platform. What the company does is they insure all the crop and livestock.

In the US and they probably own a pretty significant part of that market. And you know, imagine a farmer that really runs into challenges with weather events happening here. KX is another this year, a new partnership we have established.

KX is a high performance time series streaming database, so ***** platform technology used in sensor based platforms used by capital markets companies for what is it called quantitative trading. So just a lot of work that happens with KX. So it's a it's a fantastic company.

Aklaro, one of our customers here, I think they're here as well. We again we are starting actually Steve, I think we're all starting the kicking off the project this coming week.

And we've been engaged with them on the architecture and strategy for a while. But look, I think it's just 125 plus languages, their customers again, large tech companies building out technology for translation.

And this just incredible work that the company does. So I think that's and we have a lot of clients. We have Rotary, I'm so always inspired by the work Paul and Liz here with us. So I always thank you for joining Paul, a lot of our customers are doing.

Incredible work. So I didn't want to take the time to walk through all of them, but as you can see, there's an exciting amount of work our customers are doing in their digital journey and you're part of that.

We have another issue.

Hello is this better?

I'll restart.

I think you read every slide, so I think I think I'm fine. But so like I said, this time

usually I don't do this. I talk about leadership principles at this point. But I thought I'll actually this being the 15 year celebration of Accion, I'll tell you a little bit about how. How Accion was founded and what the journey looked like. A lot of you probably already know, especially those who have been in Accion for a long time. They they know this story, but I'll talk about some of the learnings also along the way. So if you think about it, you know this is 2010.

And I was working in another tech services business. I had my journey was building software using Java and C++ and all that. I had no idea of building a company. And as you many of you know, one of the investors, he insisted that I should start a company, so.

He used to be my ex CEO. Usually he's at the summit. This time he's not there, but he wired me \$1,000,000 and said you must start a company and it was an incredible. Moment in time where I was very nervous, unlike anyone else. You know, if you raise money, you get happy, you celebrate, you open a champagne bottle. I was not. I was doing none of that and really spending time thinking about it, what I want to do, whether I want to take this money and start the company. So anyway.

And I had no no one with me at that point in time, but the money in the bank. So what I did is I went to this trail in Bethel Park, Pennsylvania, and I met Tony Kernan. Where is Tony?

Sitting back there, so Tony, his wife, my wife and I both started walking on the trail together. We met and I said, Tony, I got money in the bank. You want to start a company. So he said, yeah, no problem. And I said we have enough money to work for a year. If we screw it up, we'll.

Go back to working for someone else. And he said, OK, that's great, I think we're safe here. And so we started the company. This is our first office in 2011 and.

I still remember these chairs. I cleaned them up myself on day one and they were left by the previous owner, so we got them for free, which is awesome. And so that's how we started the company. We hired a bunch of people. We hired a few more people along the way.

This is probably 2012 time frame. We were cash positive within the first year. So within the first year we started making profit at that time and as we progressed we we were our work life.

You know, we believed in that, so we had a lot of fun. This is one of our picnics that we did together. We did. This is our pooja, Diwali pooja going on in the office. So it was a lot of fun. This is one of the potlucks we were doing.

This is. I love this, by the way. We I love. I love a lot of things about America. I love Thanksgiving. I love. This is a very interesting thing we do in US, which is called Bring your child to work.

And just love that when children get to experience your work. And now this, this is of course a much younger child, but we had children actually talking to customers, making cold calls and so on. So it was just incredible experience producing reports, going on the board, writing status reports and some things like that.

That. So it was a lot of fun when we bring these kids together.

We had, of course, and I'll talk about it. Every Friday we would leave the office, you know, at 2:00 PM, we'll stop working completely. And I'll talk about why. And then we go to a sporting arena. You know, it could be bowling, it could be football, you know, of course, everyone was.

Being a Steelers fan everywhere in Pittsburgh.

At that point in time.

This is the first leadership meet of Axion Labs and this happened inside. Can you guess where it's being held?

At my home, on my dining table. So this is the first, you know, few of us. Shami is there.

I think we continued to grow. We set up a Bangalore Center. I think in 2012 Bangalore Center grew. Ramesh's company was acquired called Hibiscus Technology and then Ramesh's business merged with Accion. Ash was already, I think by that time part of Accion.

I don't remember the exact dates. And so this is our office. Then we actually opened up our headquarters new office. Remember that dusty office that I showed you? This is the office after that. So this is the office we set up.

Actually the dusty office, we expanded because we were more people. So we expanded that office and once we grew out of that, we ended up in this office in Pittsburgh. So I think this is sort of the opening ceremony over there.

So today, of course, Accion, you know, is in in so many geographies, so many places. So it's been an incredible journey. It hasn't been easy, but it has been amazing. So I used to tell people.

That my weekend starts on Monday morning and ends on Friday evening because we were so excited about going to office. And I still remember on a Saturday morning, sometimes I'll hop, you know, go to office and I'll see a couple of other employees there. Tony was always there on Saturday morning doing something.

We would hide from each other and we would walk into the office. So a lot of effort went in in doing that. There were tough moments also customers going bankrupt. Sears, as you know, was a very big customer of ours and Sears had been going bankruptcy for almost.

10 years, you know, I don't know. I think now they are bankrupt finally, right? But they were a significant customer of ours. So very tough moments. In about 2020, an investment group called TA Associates decided to invest in US and they put a. Their their term sheet in front of us. So the day I received the term sheet, that day our largest customer sent me a termination notice.

So that's very tough. And they said, can you come to London? We want to sign the term sheet. So I go to London, I sit across the table from the investment committee and I said I got bad news for you.

So the investors say what is the bad news and I explain them our largest customer most likely will be terminating with us. So if someone else put a better bid than us and and of course eventually that company got fired from there and we are back in the business.

With the same company, but it so happened that PA believed in the asset, they believed in the company, they believed in the leadership. They said we understand, but we know you are a good company. We would like to continue to invest in you and they signed the term sheet that day.

Not even a single dollar of that revenue we ever lost.

What happened is as and that company saw mass exodus of management because they got private equity acquired, they did an RFP, we lost the RFP, blah blah blah. Every leader that left, they said we want to work with you. So our one customer became about 11.

Customers and Anand Raja here. I want to give him a round of applause for that. He Anand, where are you?

OK, standing as always, but so it was an amazing journey and TA of course has been very happy with the investment that they've made and we have more than doubled in size. Now you may ask, OK, this is great.

Fantastic, right? OK, you started a company, it grew. Hundreds of companies go through that, right? What's so unique about you? And that's what my next section is. I will talk about that.

But I want to tell you, we were the fastest growing company out of Pittsburgh in the tech services space. We were the fastest to reach 50 million. We were the fastest to

reach 100 million, but the fastest to reach 200 million. And in the entire United States, no company has done that.

Right. So you need to know a lot of our employees don't know that.

So that is where the next question comes and I want to now talk about this. So you know, any entrepreneur feels their baby is the sweetest and the most beautiful, right? But I think I kind of introspected that what made Accion come this far. So it's a huge. Huge funnel, 10,000, 20,000 companies get founded and they keep shrinking. The funnel is very, very narrow at the bottom. Very few companies can deliver the growth. So how is that possible is what I want to now introspect with all of you with me.

Are you ready?

No one is falling asleep right here. You need a coffee. OK, All right. So I'm like I said, I'm not going to talk about AI, but I'm going to talk about something that will help you address the challenges of AI.

And you'll see that, right? Because if you think about it, all these terms, creativity, invention, innovation and discovery, they all rest upon the foundation of what called what I call as challenging the common belief.

And I attribute this idea, this thought to Ash, because Ash once told me that Kinesh, our limitation are simply our assumptions. We assume something, you know, when someone said Earth is flat.

But someone challenged that. Everyone was saying Earth is flat. Someone said Earth is the center of the universe, right? There was someone who said this assumption might be wrong. Let's challenge it. So challenging the assumption, challenging the common belief is what you will see.

Constantly we did as we built out Axion. So let's start with some of them here and I will show you. I will share some stories with you. A very common belief is hard work is key to success. A lot of people say that the harder I work.

The more, sorry, harder I work, luckier I get correct. So everyone puts a lot of effort on hard work. And so some people may say no, no, you know what, you're wrong.

Outcome focus is very important. Result orientation is very important.

But imagine this.

If you did get the outcome, but what if the outcome was wrong? You were supposed to go north. You said my outcome is South. You made it to the South in time. So your measurement is there, your timing is right, but you are at the wrong place.

Because you were supposed to go north, you ended up in South. So outcome was achieved, measurements were in place, you you met all the speed constraints. But so

here is where my point comes in that really hyper prioritisation.

Is the key to success. If you don't prioritize and we were so hyper prioritized, every day we walk in, we used to look at what is our priority. Tony, me, Ash, we constantly did that and I think our employees have seen that as we have grown and.

So many times I get on a call and I say don't do this whenever someone gives me a very large.

Excel sheet of things that he's doing. I always say chuck it off, just bring only three of them back.

Because humans cannot proceed on 10/11/12 programs, just get two or three. So do not work on too many things. And I want to share share some more interesting thoughts with you. You know what is common amongst all these successful people? This is not about business, this is about anything you do.

You look at Steve Jobs, Elon Musk, Mother Teresa, Shahrukh Khan, Mahatma Gandhi, Jeff Bezos, everyone. And most people with Indian heritage will recognize this character called Arjuna. And there's a little story around it that Arjun, he's a warrior. King and in the poem called Mahabharata, which is the world's longest poem, right? And in that poem he says, his teacher says.

Kill that bird, aim at the bird. And so all students keep missing. But Arjuna always gets it right. So the teacher asks, why are you always? How are you able to get it right? He says. I don't see the. I don't see the forest. I don't see the tree. I don't see the.

Bird. What do I see?

Eyes of the bird. I'm only seeing the eyes of the bird. So you can see the bird has become so big. Actually it's a small bird. So the idea is when you walk in on any day into a into your office, you have tons of projects.

You have to decide which one you want to shoot, which one you want to aim at, and you need to be an urgent at that point in time and say I'm going to kill this bird and finish it off today. And so having that ability to prioritize now you say, OK, that's all good.

How did we do it? So this is what a Friday morning looked like at Axial. As you see, the beer bottles are waiting. Steelers, we are going to play a touch football very soon. I literally prioritize for the beer, so we would come into the office.

First thing in the morning, we put all the tasks that we have on top of us and the job I did was to strike them off saying we're not doing this, we're not doing this, we're not doing this. We're leaving at 2:00 PM. The game starts at 2:00 PM. That's it. That's how

we did that. And even today, a lot of leaders.

When they get on calls with me, they see that that I prioritize for them. So that's one thing is that's not hard work, it's hyper prioritization. That's why I said you don't have to read all the leadership books. They will give you anecdotes. They won't tell you what Steve Jobs was thinking. Steve Jobs was hyper, hyper focused on what. Made sense to him, right? The next common belief is clients know what they want. Make it happen, right? That's not true. So of course a lot of this is not. Everyone knows that we have to go beyond the ask, offer ideas and thoughts, and we did that. And that story I want to tell you now.

In a different way, this is our first customer. Our very first customer in the history of the company was a company called Anderson Merchandisers. It's a very large retail company in the United States. They actually supply CDs, DVDs to.

And their largest supplier of Walmart and Tony and I, we had never met them. It was all over the phone and.

It's very interesting. We were one of the 12 partners, OK, or 10 partners at this company and we used to work with a customer and those were the days when we used to do staff augmentation. So we would actually send talent to their offices and Charlene, I think that was her name.

And Tony and I would just work so hard to compete with 10 other partners, but we would basically get 100K business, 200K business. So we thought about it saying, hmm, let's let's change this.

So what we did is we did a call with the customer and we said Charlene, you are doing, you know you're working so hard every day to get your team from so many vendors, so many partners.

I would like to tell you that there is another way to get the talent and they had a very strict rule that you cannot use green cards and H1. So very simple idea, right? I created a PowerPoint slide and walked them through, walked Charlene through the idea.

That you need hundreds of engineers. If you expand your pool, you will be a winner. So after 20 minute call, Charlene says not convinced, hangs up the phone. So Tony and I look at each other and Tony says now what I said Tony.

We have given an idea. Let it play out in our mind.

Sure, it did. Two days later, Tony gets a text message saying, remember the idea that you shared? I'd like to talk more about it. I have some questions. I said, Tony, we're in business. You won't believe we were the top partner within three months.

And this customer became the largest customer in year one of Accion Labs. So and all the other partners were behind us. Why? We brought a new idea and that happens every day at Accion. We are all trying to do that, right? Try to bring a new idea to the table.

The next one is it's very interesting. Common belief is be client centric. Customer centricity is taught in MBA schools every day. Even today people say be customer centric, be customer centric. What people don't understand is.

There are a lot of stakeholders in the business. You have clients, you have employees, you have vendor partners.

So.

And and what we did is from day one, I told our team, everyone is important, not just the customer. And if we take care of our vendors and our employees, customer centricity promise will be delivered.

Right. That's what you want. You want customers to be happy. And So what? I want to tell you this another story here. This is Debbie, our head of finance. And those were the days when small companies would manage their cash flow like crazy. And one of the way to manage cash flow is to not pay vendors.

Very easy. If you delay the payment to vendors, automatically your cash flow becomes manageable. So Debbie came to me saying Ginesh, invoices are pending, vendor is waiting for the payments. What do I do? Should I pay or not pay? I said Debbie, very simple rule.

All vendors should be paid on time. We are not going to improve our cash flow by taking money from our vendors and making them suffer. This particular principle, we're taking care of all stakeholders was very helpful to us because we were.

Partnering with a lot of other companies and you know once you do something wrong with the partner A, the B gets to know about it and so creating that credibility is key.

Here's another one common belief. It's actually statistically proven 50% of all mergers fail. You can you can see that and MBA books tell tell you that it's OK, it's OK, 50% fails for a company like us, 50% can't fail. So we said 100% of them how to work.

Here it is 9 mergers over the 15 year period. Not even a single failed.

How did we do that? What we did is first of all we said well we are acquiring company for leaders and talent. We're not acquiring for revenues and customers. Of course they are good, but very important is acquisition. Second thing is we

integrated at a pace that they were comfortable with, not not past pace which is what?

Everyone says you just integrate fast, but that's not what we did. What we did is we integrated at a pace that they were comfortable with. We didn't look for cost synergies. That means we didn't consolidate HR, finance, recruiting to save a few \$100,000. We just said you bring the capability, you bring talent.

Let's grow together and all our acquisitions with us have grown. That's called frontline synergy. The other thing we did is culture transformation is very dangerous. That means you don't want to change the culture of the incoming organization. What you want to do is amalgamate, mix it up.

So when we acquired Ezeest, Ezeest in their culture, they had a tagline called Zest for Life. We took that Zest for life and added it on our culture tagline was Thrive and we made what is called Thrives. So you see Thrives banners over here. The Z comes from Ezeest because we felt it was incredible.

That they thought about zest for life as a part of the culture. So this helped us. So more beliefs. This is another interesting one. Create a good plan and execute to the plan to the T It's very common belief.

Here's Axion belief. Create a good plan. Allow the plan to change, and I'll tell you another story on that. So this is.

One of our sales leaders in 2012, 13, maybe 14, our head of HR, Amy and myself, ChatGPT could do that. So I'm experimenting with ChatGPT, but as you can see. Were ready to terminate. So I told Amy, let's call John. John is not doing very well. It's been two years. He hasn't produced anything.

We should let him go. Amy works hard. She creates a performance report, a termination letter and final paycheck, and we're ready to fire this individual.

As I bring him in the room, he says, John says, Ganesh, I know why you brought me in the room. I've been a failure for two years and it's I can understand why you would like to fire me, but I have an idea and he says.

Hmm, sorry, he says. Kinesh, I know I was a failure in sales, but I can do recruiting for you. Would you consider that in my mind? Remember, the facts changed.

I would have Amy was wanted to go to her next next work, so she wanted to just be done with it. And I said, John, I think we'll give you a shot to become a recruiter.

Today he's the best recruiter in Axion Labs.

You know, 10 years later.

So never go. Definitely go with a plan, but don't stick to it. If facts change, if

information changes, be prepared to change it. So Mahatma Gandhi said that don't expect me to be consistent with the past.

Expect me to be consistent with the facts.

Imagine that. We're all data experts here, but Mahatma Gandhi said that, you know, 70 years ago. So it's very amazing that you have to be open to change when you don't want to just execute to the plan, right? Here is another one.

People say employees are important. Take care of them.

We said no employees are. So this is all lip service to employees. People are HR organization. Employees are important. We simply changed the belief. We said employee is equal to the customer and you might say, oh, OK, that's another talk. Ginesh Doshi is going on the stage and talking about it. But we do this every moment.

If any employee has the visa problem, I personally get involved. If any employee has an issue about career pathing, I challenge people. We get on calls. If someone, even an ex employee sends an e-mail, I didn't get my experience certificate, we respond very quickly.

Employees as important as an existing employee. So employee is equal to customer and that mindset came from this story where we said look, you think about a hotel and hotel front desk. If you think about it on a hotel and in some ways we are in hospitality business is what I tell people.

That you, your employee checks in, you welcome them, but there is one day that employee is going to check out.

What do you do when your customer checks out? Do you get angry? You get upset? You start yelling what you're why you're leaving me? You don't do that. You actually treat them like the customer and someday they'll come back. Accion has one of the largest number of return employees, and many of them are actually in this room. Why? Because we treated them well when they were leaving. Not only when they were coming. Everyone is happy when people join. But when you are happy and you come when a person is leaving, that's what true leadership is all about. South. This is something very close to our heart, and we always do that. In fact, Katrina, if you're here, can you stand up?

Let's welcome her first time to India. Caterina knows that she manages my time and calendar. I devote exactly equal amount of time to customers and employees. You will see that at the summit I will spend exactly the same amount of time with employees that I would spend with customers and many of them have.

Experience that over years, over years, over years because they are exactly. And so you like employees are important. Employees. This is all *****. Employees are the customer and that's the message that we share. Here's another common belief.

Companies have line and staff organization. Another MBS peak, by the way.

In MBA, they teach us what is called line staff, line roles and staff roles. What they are basically saying is line roles are along with revenue. That means sales, delivery, manufacturing, all this called line and and staff roles are like.

HR, finance and all that and they are called support organizations and Accion believe everyone is a line function. There is everyone supports business, everyone is in the line of revenue and that means everyone plays an ink. And so this diagram actually shows that and by the way.

This is an unspoken hierarchy in business. People don't talk about it, but if you think about it, the one who owns the customer is considered to be the most powerful in most organizations. The one who owns execution, they usually report to the sale and all the support people are under them.

At Accion, everyone is a first class citizen. From day one, we treated HR recruiters.

Recruiter can yell at sales, delivery can yell at sales if they did something wrong. And you're creating that equality amongst all functions and making them feel that they are.

As first class citizen and they're on the top.

Here's the next common belief. I'll take a few more minutes and then wrap up, guys.

You need a list of competitors to rally. This is another amazing thing. You know this is promoted by sports, right? We say Steelers compete with, you know, Baltimore Ravens. India is against Pakistan.

New Zealand is again UK sports. Three hour. You want thrill? Yes, think about your competitors. But life is not like that. Business is not about competing with competitors. Business is about forgetting about your competitors and just focus on besting.

Yourself. And so does that mean we ignore all competitors? No, but we don't consider them as competitors. We consider them as learning experts. We learn from all, but copy none. And at Axiom, that's the rule. Don't come and tell me Cognizant does this or Accenture does this.

This or IBM does this. Tell me why it is relevant to us and what can I learn from Accenture? What can I learn from? So here's another this story. I want to tell you an interesting story.

One of our customers.

Very significant customer. I happened to be in their office in LA and we were and I happened to be there. I didn't know, but I was told there was a celebration of a global release. So they said why don't you? I walked into the room and the client and I both stood up in front of a team and we actually.

You know, thank the team and all these good words of leadership shared with them. We appreciated everyone's work in the room. There were not all the grey shirts are Axion, all the blue shirts are a competitor. So the team, the the project was done by two parties together and we together did very well.

So customer left and I started shaking hands with everyone on the Accion side with the Gray shirts. Remember, there were no shirt colours at that time. I didn't know who is who. So the program manager, she was standing behind me and she came to me saying, you all the people on the other side of the table are from competitor. I said, So what? They contributed to the delivery. I will shake their hands as well. So I shook hands and I said, I I know you're from mind tree, but thank you so much. Yeah, thank you so much. Thank you so much. And I walked out of the room. I forgot because remember, to me, that's not a competitor. If someone contributed, they did a great job. You should appreciate that.

There was no ulterior motive in this interaction. Two years later, customer decided to terminate this partner and give all the work to us.

And customer said to all those employees, you can join another partner and they gave option Accion and another partner. Who do you think they all went to?

Accion Labs, they all said the CEO came, shook hands and thanked us two years ago because the customer gave a choice. You can join A or B and they all came to Accion Labs. There was no ulterior motive, but I just didn't consider a competitor over there. Right. So hope you see some of that. Here's another one, very common one.

Delegate more, blah blah blah, right? Don't do micromanagement. It's a bad idea. All that, right? It's again taught in MBA schools. You need to learn delegation.

Remember that.

Place we are all today where so much of change is happening in such a short period of time. People managers have 0 value. If the only skill you have is to manage people, that means you are master delegator. You have no value in this new economy.

So what our from the day one I said micromanagement is not always a bad thing. Sometimes it's bad, right? If I track your time in the morning or if I check your

expenses every day, that's a bad thing. Details helps you become a value based leader, not a people manager. So micromanagement is generally.

Literally not a bad thing as long as you're in the details. And many of you know that when I get a PowerPoint slide deck, I review every slide. I don't just say great, nice slide deck, right? I'm reviewing it because I want to know the details. A lot of people this morning I walked with Karthick to understand what is he presenting today.

Because I want to know the details and you'll see that next two days I'll listen to every presentation. I probably will understand only half of it, but it'll be worth it, right? So you want to not. So yeah, this is the boss saying just get it done, right? That doesn't work nowadays, so you have to be in the details.

Another one innovation can only be done by innovators and we said no anyone can do innovation. Innovation opportunity exists everywhere. This is an example what a learning team did is they started doing Democon.

Which we do every Thursday. How many of you are attending Democons? Raise your hand.

OK, good. We still see only half the participation, but learning team innovated this.

This is not a blockchain developer. This is not a drone technology. It's very simple.

But here is another technology our recruitment team innovated. We call it hooked on talent where interviews can be done offline in a video mode.

So I can actually say interview can happen offline and I can watch the video of the candidate at a later point in time, right? And I can say let me compare these three candidates and I can move quickly. Our customers love that.

Here's an employee communication. This was done by HR. HR came up with the idea of let's do an employee communication tool. And of course now we do the Spectrum magazine. So I think just kind of giving you this idea that innovation is not just innovators or technologies word. Anyone could be an innovator.

Other.

People say is utilization and by the way unspoken rule of IT services is focus on billing, billing, billing, billing. Right from the get go we created non billing teams in Accion. We have a lot of people come to me. We have Co leaders, we have stack leaders. There's zero. We have IP teams, 5060 people non billable right? You guys see that?

All of you. And that is because not everyone needs to be billing. This is another one. I was told Innovation Summit can only be done by large companies. Of course we did it. We started it 12 years ago, so we were probably a three-year old as a company.

And this is the picture of some of our earliest Innovation Summit that we did. And you know, it was just amazing. A very small group would get together and talk about innovation. So it applies to every. In fact, I got e-mail saying you're wasting money, right? And I said no, we believe in that. It's a great platform. Let's continue that.

Organizations are limited by availability of time. I'm trying to speed up here are limited by availability of time and dollars. Most people think I don't have time, I don't have dollars. But there is the most scarcest resource is this attention at the top. It's also known as mind space.

Because what is below is calendar space, but your mind has to be and you think about it. Sometimes your mind is devoted to something. Even though you have all the time in the world, you are able to not able to focus. So that is something we said. This is another funny one.

Employees will never come back to office. This was being told in post COVID. Everyone said every all our.

Peers in the industry said now once and for all, everyone will go home and they won't come back. Our investors said, can we reduce our space? Our CFO said should we let it go? I said no, we're going to sting. Everyone is going to come back, OK, because you need to inside a physical space to create retention.

Create career growth and create innovation. And here is a picture. See this woman? She's distracted. Can you do creativity with this? Can you do innovation with this? You cannot. Believe me, companies are falling behind and that's why I keep telling our organization, our leaders.

Please come back together in a physical space. No company can innovate. This company will be gone very soon. Look at this. These guys are collaborating. They're on the board. They're enjoying each other. They're smiling. So that's something that we believed in. And a lot of CEOs came to me saying, no, no, no, no, this will work. All remote. I said no, it's not going to happen. I was part of the CEO group was on panel discussions. Here's another one. We must attain work life balance. Everyone says who wants to attain work life balance.

Who has achieved work life balance?

Anyone. OK, some people have, so maybe.

So we believe balance is not possible, but harmony is possible and this is what I mean by.

Take a glass of wine and enjoy it. But if a customer calls and says, hey, we have a

production issue, you put on your pants.

I don't know why I said that, but.

That was not part of the script, by the way, and you go to office and so we would get into action. But that's like work life harmony. Work life harmony is not. I don't spend enough time with my son. I have told this in the prior sessions, that is, I will fly kite this weekend with my son.

Couldn't do it this weekend. I'll do it next weekend. That's called harmony. That will distress you from trying to balance life. I have a few more and I will do it quickly now. Please read this through. IP should generate revenue.

IP should generate impact. Hire slow, fire fast. By the way, this is actually a CEO investor of Google said that hire slow, fire fast. I say hire fast, fire slow. You saw that example of Jason. I didn't fire him.

I gave him an opportunity and it is. It has been such a successful ride with him. So don't fire people quickly. Give them an opportunity, right? The more we play, the more we win. That's not true, by the way. OK, the more we leave.

The more we win. What I mean by that is, you know, you don't play a lot of cricket matches to win. You'll be tired. So you play the ones that are worth winning. That's what you ought to do. If you know, we have someone said, you know, you need to lose more to win. By the way, that's also and I was, I was flabbergasted.

By that, how can that happen, right? How can how can losing will go if if Indian cricket team after losing to South Africa were to come and said, well, we're celebrating failures because someone told losing is good. Is losing ever good? It's never good. So learn from it.

Right, but don't celebrate it. This is another one. Invest only if client pays. This is another IT services rule. Do not make people travel if customer is not paying. At Accion we have done hundreds of travels right without customer paying.

A lot of companies in IT services, they hire younger people to improve your gross margin. Yeah, that's a term that hired. They call it pyramidization. These are humans. You're calling pyramidization, right? But if you think about it, you hire younger people to do idea generation.

That's what you do.

This is another one. Know what you do well and I would say true, but know what you don't do well. OK, we used to have a web page on Axion website called What Don't We Do for many years. We removed it eventually because we did so much more. But there used to be a web page called What don't we know? Here is the last one

and I will say that this is another interesting one. Avoid conflict. Agree to disagree.

It's a very dangerous thing if an organization agrees to disagree.

That means one person is going to be unhappy always in every debate.

OK, because I agree to disagree. I'm not going to cause conflict. He walks away and he only hopes you will fail.

Right. So we say this debate and disagree to agree. That means start from a very long, crazy debate and get to a point where you both agree. If you don't agree, do not do get on the project.

And disagree to agreement is something we do. If you come to, you know, in Orlando office there was a almost a fight broke up between 2 leaders because they were debating on something that and and we said, yeah, this is good. We want you both to fight it out and agree.

So it's not agree to disagree, disagree to agree. So you can see that this is what we call as axionisms, and I've covered a few. There's a lot more happens every day. We challenge assumptions and there is no better time than now.

I would urge each one of you to make find one assumption around you that you have made or your peers have made, and you want to challenge that and challenge the assumptions, shatter the beliefs, make every impossible into possible.

That's what innovation mindset is all about. Thank you so much for listening to me and I really appreciate all the time.

And do change your seats.

Hello.

Yes.

Can you hold going to the?

Do for another hour.

I could not. So before Ginesh finished, I had a visit. So I to be fair, I wanted to ask you before I start.

Many people ask me, you have never worn a jacket in the summit before. How come suddenly you're now becoming so formal? So.

Huh.

Yeah, so I want to tell you this is not just by happen chance. I truly believe so far that what defined me was that I'm a coder.

I always pride myself in saying I know how to write code, therefore I'm a good engineer.

And I think last year I started questioning that assumption of saying is it good

enough that I'm only able to write code? Is that why I'm successful? And I think last year.

We talked about this and I introduced this term called a semantic engineer.

And the semantic engineer was something that we talked about. I don't need to talk about that. That's me. This is what I presented last year. We said semantic engineers will stop.

Um.

We are going to stop building and we are start going to start orchestrating. We are going to stop looking at solutions and we are going to start looking at experiences. We'll stop doing maintenance and we'll start doing governance. We'll stop being concerned about security and we'll start worrying about ethics.

I'm not going to not going to deep dive into this because we did it last year. So whoever missed it, please look up and last year's presentations.

The question I want to talk about this year is, has this changed? Has this really materialised? Is this some kind of futuristic concept that is going to happen sometime in future or is it really practical?

And what is happening on the ground?

You know, we presented the last year's summit in March.

2095 this year we are having the summit slightly earlier than March.

From March of 2025 till February of 2026.

What we have been hearing about.

The kind of transformation and changes that are going to happen in our industry have been, I would say never before has that happened that there is so much of chatter that is going on in our industry and I want to give you a little bit of timeline. Of what I have been hearing through this year. So I'm gonna start with April 2025. I remember in 2024 Satya had already said SaaS is dead.

OK, that was the context of our last year's summit. In April, a month after that, there was a llama con, Satya Nadella said. Maybe 20 to 30% of the code inside our repositories.

Are written is written by software and not by human beings. In the same conference, Mark Zuckerberg said the next year, probably half the development is going to be done by AI. Kevin Scott, CTO of Microsoft, not in the same event, but in.

In one of the published articles said 95% of all code will be written generated by AI by 20-30. Sam Altman said agents can do real work, cognitive work, write computer code. Writing computer code will never be the same again.

On the other hand, we heard from one of the gurus of software engineering, Kent Beck, who's the creator of Extreme Programming, one of the co-authors of the Agile Manifesto, who said.

Like most of us has been, we have been experimenting in working with these new tools and one of their observation is the genie. He calls it the genie seems to assume that it's it's.

Planetary sized brain is capable of handling any amount of complexity.

OK. And he also observed that the only way to reduce complexity is to manually design.

There was a METR, which is Model Evaluation and Threat Research report in July of last year. When developers are allowed to use AI tools, they take 19% longer to complete tasks.

Uh, he was the chief scientist of Meta.

He saw through almost 12 years, if I'm mistake not, he was in Meta. In December of 2025, he announced his. I think he announced his resignation in November and he actually resigned in.

December, and he has been a big proponent of actually calling out the limitations of LLMS. And he said LLMS have a superficial understanding because they manipulate language without any true notion of the underlying physical reality. And he started a new company.

Focusing on world models.

In January of this year, the CEO of Anthropic said AI models could do most, maybe all of what software engineers currently do within 6 to 12 months. This was January of this year, just about a month ago.

He visited the India AI Summit, which was earlier this month, and he clarified that doesn't mean that we don't need engineers anymore. They'll just do different things. But chatter is there and you know that he.

Probably caused a huge, massive fall in stock prices by some of the statements he's made. So we have to be a little careful in how we interpret these kind of statements. One of our old favorites, Ryan Dahl, creator of Node JS, he said the era of humans writing code is over. That's not to say that software engineers don't have work to do, but writing syntax directly.

Is not it.

At the beginning of this year, Thoughtworks had a private conference where they had only invitees, and they invited some of the really luminaries of this industry. And

the CTO of Thoughtworks, Rachel, actually published her findings from that conference.

And she made the statement. Writing code was never the bottleneck.

The velocity that you can get from AI.

Becomes a debt accelerator. So if you allow it and you adopt it blindly, they're very likely that you're just going to increase your technical debt. 2 days back there was a summit or the pragmatic summit.

In which Laura, the CTO of DX, said for dysfunctional organizations, AI simply makes them dysfunctional faster, leading to twice as many customer facing incidents.

So whom do we believe, right? On the one hand, you have all these.

Statements which sort of predict the demise of us engineers. On the other hand, you have the practitioners who are still clinging. If you look at it from their point of view, this is still clinging to no, no, no, you know, we'll still be there. We're going to be doing different things.

What's the true reality of all of this? What I'd like to focus on, and I think the entire summit this year is going to be focusing on grounded realities.

Not hype. So we're going to try this year to focus on really grounded outcomes that we have achieved and we are likely to achieve like Inesh said on Monday morning and this is not some kind of futuristic.

Idea summit of any kind. So to truly understand what is possible and what is not possible, this is a little bit of setting the ground truth for all of us. This is certainly not new, but I want to make sure that what are we?

We talk about. Henceforth we set these ground truths. If you have a problem with any of the statements I'm making here, then anything that follows will not hold true.

So you need to either accept the assumptions I'm making in this section.

Or ignore everything else that I'm saying if you don't believe in some of these. So the first one is what can foundation models do? They are basically trained on enormous amount of data which is there on the Internet. It is a statistical pattern matching algorithm. It knows how to predict the next.

Token based on whatever tokens it has been given, either as part of the training or based on the context of the prompt that you allow that you provided. It has extremely high contextual accuracy, it seems.

Weird that it actually can say things that you would have said and almost like you can read your thoughts. It's as uncanny as that, and so the the accuracy of outputs are very, very good.

You can get actual working code. You can get tremendous amount of document analysis. You can get reasoning. You can get coherent conversations. Brilliant. I've never had so much fun writing code as I'm doing now.

With cloud code, no undebatable, great amount of fun.

One step further, what can agents do? They can not only take individual decisions like the LLMS can do, they can also plan a set of tasks. They can use tools. You can train them to use tools. They can execute multiple tasks that they plan and they can orchestrate across multiple agents.

It's almost like unbelievable kind of capability that we have in technology today.

If you put both these together, that's what's causing the hype. The thing if you have a technology that is able to learn and talk language and not only just English and other languages, but even code.

And so much of our digital economy is based on code. It must be true that now you can rely on these technologies to be able to start generating code and therefore doing digital transformation automatically.

And why only one? You can have this whole swarm of agents and all of us will be on the beach having fun and the agents will be doing all our work. Super future to.

Look forward to. Is that the reality? Unfortunately, there are some limitations on these technologies as well. So what are they? First is they do not understand our business. If you give a prompt and you give a context, they know exactly what needs to be done based on what.

Information you give them. They have no insight into the kind of regulatory environment that we're working in. They don't have the commitments that we have made to our customers. They don't have architectural constraints. They don't have the kind of cultural realities that we have in our organization. It doesn't have visibility into that.

It can plan, code, test, deploy code, but it can tell you that the code actually ran, but it doesn't know whether the code actually does what it was supposed to do.

This is another big problem. They can hallucinate with extreme level of confidence. Whether they are right or wrong, they'll still give you an answer that is technically correct. It'll run the code, but you give it requirements, right? And it's like saying OK, it's a statistical algorithm.

If you give it three points and you try to interpolate 3 points, you will get a line with a particular slope. If you give it three more points, it'll give you a line based on those three points, not the first three points. The problem is the first three points were

related to the next three points in my head.

With a certain relationship, yeah, it doesn't know the relationship. So it's just drawing the line based on what you three points you gave it, OK, and so confident. There's no way it's wrong because those three points, this line fits.

There's no debate and you will believe it because point wise it's it's right. It's not wrong. Why do we call it a hallucination? Because in my head there was some different line expected. Because I remember in my head that those earlier three points have some relationship to these new three points.

So hallucination is is just an outcome of the capability of the technology to be able to draw insights to predict the next token based on the prompt you give, based on the context you give it, and it's not its fault that it does not know.

It is doing exactly what it's supposed to do. It's that you did not give it sufficient information to be able to draw the right conclusions. So you may get code generation, but there is no guarantee that it's going to do what you thought you wanted. The problem is all the requirements are in our head.

OK, our user story is not representative of true requirements. Our design diagrams do not specify everything in detail. So what happens? I've given three points. In my head there is some picture.

But it's just going to draw a line, think, well, these three points, brilliant. Here is the line and that's the code it's going to write. And there's no guarantee that that's the code you actually wanted. That's the risk that we are facing today.

And the other part of it is it does it so fast.

OK, you don't have time.

To take care of the kind of mistakes that you've done. It's not that human beings don't make mistakes, right? We are all human. We know we all write wrong code. We make security errors, we make mistakes. But at our pace, at human pace, we have the time to be able to fix those issues.

Now, if we blindly go ahead with this technology and let it loose in our engineering projects, it's very likely that you don't have the time to be able to do verification of whether what you did, what you got was actually right or not. So there.

Yeah, there are there are risks in the verification speed.

This is another big problem. At the POC level, you don't worry about the token usage. You don't worry about the cost of paying for your subscriptions. The minute you start operating at scale, expenses are going to start piling up exponentially.

This is not a linear thing. The minute you write one agent, it's going to occupy

tokens. The second agent is going to be occupying more tokens and you put a swarm of agents. They're going to get a swarm of tokens and then suddenly your whole cost is going to go.

Haywire altogether. So at some point when this is truly put into practice, you cannot ignore the kind of costs that are going to get involved.

So if you look back on all the statements that people made, they are all right.

It's not that they were wrong. OK, So what the technology can do is that it can translate a detailed requirement. If you give a detailed requirement, if you give a well-defined context, it can generate a well-defined syntax.

Surely possible, extremely fast. But this is the easy part of what we do. OK? What it can't do is the hard part, which is what do you build? Why do you build it? For whom do you build it? Does it actually work? Can you trust it? Can you afford it?

This is the hard part and it is not shrinking. It is growing because now we are accelerating the pace of writing the code and now we have to worry about all these questions more than we ever did, faster than we ever did, and we don't have the habit of doing this on a regulated basis.

And a scalable basis. He may be doing this. I have this corner office of AVB. Maha is here. We have a Axion architecture value board, process value board. OK, they are working at manual speed today.

OK, how are we going to scale up that? How are we going to worry about governance when all our engineers start using AI to be able to write the code? So this is not a trivial exercise. So the hard parts.

Is where the problem is. The easy bit is what we focus on. OK, so easy bit is certainly good news. But to really get advantage, take advantage of these technologies, we have to worry about what AI can't do yet. We have to worry about what will.

When we deploy it, we have to worry about what do we need to make or do to make it work at scale. That is what we are going to focus on this year. So to do that, I want to take you through four primary risk areas. We already talked about them. I'm going to explicitly call this out.

Thanks to Nano Banana for all the artistry. Um.

1st is we talked about it. They are stateless models. They can only work on the context that you give it. The reality of today is that most of the context of processes that we have, whether it is software engineering or any other enterprise processes.

The information that we need to be able to execute these processes is in unstructured data. Some of it exists in our digital stores. We have a data lake, but

and we have systems like we have Salesforce and ServiceNow and all of that stuff. But 80% of the actual decisions need some kind of structured, unstructured information that is in people's heads. OK, so we are going to talk about how do we address this.

And as a result of this, the most important thing we need for addressing this risk is that we need some kind of major shift in the enterprise architecture strategy. OK. So how do we transform from our traditional data layer to a sort of enterprise context layer?

Is one of the things that we'll need to worry about and we need to address if we are going to expect the kind of results we want. As part of this summit, we have these sessions which are going to focus on this area, right? So Mandar is going to, I'm going to.

Let these names be in these slides because that's how I refer to them. There will be a detailed schedule and you will have it in the apps if you have them. And if you search for this name, you'll find which session I'm talking about. So please excuse the way I'm referring to these.

Because that's for me, it's easier to remember who's talking rather than the topic they're talking. In some cases, the topic may not be matching the actual topic they're talking. But just to give you an idea about how we are covering the different topics in this summit, the first risk that we are talking about is how do you avoid.

Context collapse. So Mandar is going to talk about how, like I explained, most of the context in our enterprises is lying in unstructured data, which is not in your data lake, not in your platforms, and you have to build an architecture which is different from what is the current architecture. Mandar will help us cover that.

Karthick in his session is going to say, OK, how do we take that unstructured data and put it in our context layer?

Do we do the traditional ETL process which we are used to or do we have to come up with a new kind of methodology to ingest unstructured data? And he's going to talk about how ECL Entity Context Linking is a new version of ETL that will allow us to be able to build meaningful.

Contextual models from unstructured data in the SDLC space. We have been working the longest in this area, of course, because we are software engineers. Last year Nischal did talk about semantic engineering. We introduced Breeze. We talked about how we are able to build.

Ontologies to be able to represent functional architecture, design and code as 4

ontologies. I think we talked about the theories last year. This year we are going to be talking about how we have actually used them in software development projects. How did our semantic engineering process actually pan out on a day-to-day basis? Who is doing what? How is it actually working? How do you use cloud code with semantic engineers?

How do you use? How do you build agents? How do you, how does a designer work? How does a product owner work? What are they doing differently from what they're doing today? That's what Nischal is going to cover and Aniruddha is going to demonstrate some of the methodologies how we are using it.

Amol is going to talk about an actual implementation of the semantic engineering process for one of our clients to give you some real feedback about what's the kind of benefits they got from it.

Remember one of the important things about context is it's not just about one time context. It means when you're actually working through your process, it needs to have memory about what it did before. And we saw earlier that large language models by themselves are not capable of doing that, so at an architectural level.

So you can build memory for case specific memory, right? You can build some kind of tools, say no, I'm going to remember this because it's important for me based on my understanding of the workflow. But if you're going to let agents take their own decisions, you have to build memory at an architectural level, not on a use case level. OK, so Dvarak is going to be talking about this intelligence debt is what he's calling it, and he's going to say how do we architecturally build memory so that agents are still becoming autonomous without us having to train them on how to remember things.

So this is the first risk. The second risk is, you know, this is this whole enterprises are going to be autonomous, right? They're going to run themselves. Agents are going to run my business and.

What is the real ground truth and what's the risk here? We know that agents can perform actions. There's no debate about that. OK? The question is, should they work independently or not?

OK, so the current reality of our information architecture is that we have a patchwork of different systems. We have silos of data, we have silos of platforms. Many of them are SAS platforms where all.

Data sits. We don't even have our own data in our own place. Lot of issues.

So if we expect that agents are going to be able to execute processes on their own

using the data that we have and not what we build for them.

M.

They have to rely on the mess that we have created.

As human beings, we know how to deal with the mess at our pace.

If you throw an agent at it, just like we said, you throw a agent at writing code, it will give you flawlessly working code, but it will do Jack **** for you.

I'm not interested.

OK, which is why the METR report gave you results like you know the kind of results they said people get slower because they have to keep fixing the issues that he is doing. OK, so by itself it's not there. But if you ask Amol, he'll say if you follow the process.

We completed a project that was seemingly impossible to do in the kind of timelines that they were given, but they did manage it way ahead of time and the kind of accolades that that customer is giving these people is is worth watching.

It's superb. We have never heard of this kind of praise for some of our teams. You know, it's really, really heartening to see how successful they have been. So if you do it right, the kind of benefits you get are tremendous. But if we blindly go after it and say, oh.

Why is it so complicated? I've used cloud code. I know the kind of magic it generates. Why should I not give all my developers cloud code and they're going to get magic? They'll get magic.

For one day, two day, maybe one Sprint, 2 Sprint and then it's going to hit you.

OK, so let's be a little bit prudent here. We know it's going to work, but not unless you do your homework and do your prep adequately. It's hard work to do that.

It's not straightforward. Yes, we have built tools to make sure that context models can be generated without too much of manual effort. All that is there, but that is necessary. We cannot be fooled by the kind of hype we hear in the market to say, oh, now everybody's going to be all code is going to be written magically by AI, so.

Let's just throw the copilots and cloud codes into the mix and let's see what they can generate.

Frustrating but.

Great opportunity.

For all of us, um.

In the summit, Mandar is going to be talking about how to do this. How do you take all these siloed information and how do you build the enterprise context model?

Nitin and his group who are focusing on platforms are going to cover how do you use the contextual model to actually create benefits. We are going to be Co presenting. Nitin is going to Co present again with Shikhar from Choice Bank. Last year they both presented about what are the kind of.

Homework that Choice Bank has done to set up their framework and this year Choice Bank is going to show you the kind of benefits they got out of the investments they made in the kind of foundation they've built. I think it's a great case study and a great learning experience for us as well.

And they are going to talk about a sort of five stage blueprint of how you can leverage the kind of enterprise context model and start making getting real benefits. The third area that we are very excited by is.

Spec as a product so.

Lot of us are product companies. We have products and platforms and the question is.

What is your product? Is it the code we wrote?

Because what we protect today is the code. What you know we get, we get paid for the code we write and if code is going to be generated automatically, yes, if we do all the right things, then what is the code?

It's throw away. That means the shelf life of code is going to reduce even further. So what's going to remain and how do we make sense out of it? So we're going to be talking about idea which is not just concept, we're going to show you how it works.

This spec as a product, which means the context that we build is not merely.

To do what we are doing yesterday, we can redefine what we do as a product. We don't have to keep writing the same current applications and menu driven applications anymore. We can redefine what is a product.

If we build the right context, so in terms of autonomy, we should be looking at not just how to automate the products we build yesterday, we should be looking at what products can we build if we can automate the whole process.

Isn't that the right question to ask? Instead of looking back and seeing what products we built, oh, now can we do it with less number of engineers? We should be looking at, oh, now so exciting because we now have a new capability, a new toy to play with.

And what kind of new innovation can be built out of that?

The third risk is the economic trap. We talked about that cost can go crazy. OK, I'm not going to dive too deep and I you understand this, right? So basically if you keep

using these tools, it's likely to get expensive and it'll get expensive, very expensive, very fast before you.

So excuse me, we have a bunch of topics on the TCOS aspect. The first thing is we know last year we talked about Gen. AI in a box, which is many of our clients have compliance constraints, they have regulatory constraints they cannot use.

Cloud hosted models. So we had created a solution that we call Gen. AI in a box partnered with Dell and Lenovo so that we are able to create out-of-the-box solutions on premise. The problem is.

When you actually have production level jobs.

It doesn't scale. That means even if you have on premise, your costs will go up even if it is on premise. In fact, it'll go faster. It'll grow faster likely if you give it the right amount of juice. So it's not cheaper just because you hosted it on premise.

Is a cost benefit analysis. But the the thing we are going to look at is how do you make small models as good as large models. One of the key capabilities is reasoning. Small models do not know how to do reasoning and so Bhargav is going to present. How do you allow small models to scale at reasoning, which will give one lever to address the economic challenge? The second one is of course Genia in a Box new version with a partnership with IMNT.

What this is going to allow us to do is basically scale up our on premise loads without necessarily investing in too much of hardware. So the ROI of our on premise investments is going to become much higher and we are very excited by this partnership because many of our clients who have compliance constraints and who have already.

We started using Janei in a box for some of the prototypes and initial solutions. When it scales, we are going to try and make sure that they don't get into this economic trap of investing too much money on premise by using the Diamante solution.

Jan here is going to talk about his actual experience in core search and what is the kind of benefits that he sees. And he's talking about a very crucial thing. I was saying up to 90% benefits.

The easy bit is from 90 to 95% is where the gap between the cup and the lip.

So it's going to be very interesting to look at it from an actual practitioner's point of view of saying how do you get real benefits and what are the kind of challenges and how do you address those challenges?

Again, the specs as a product is going to look at cost because in addition to spec as

a product, there is one more secret tool that has come into existence. It always was there, but it's got suddenly new relevance.

That is local first, which means you know what's local first. Basically you can deploy your application with local storage. You can create a local storage, you can create a SWE. We talked about SWEZ like 10 years ago in the Innovation Summit.

OK, when local storage just became feasible and you could just open an application and say install it on my local system and it will run locally and you have now advanced capabilities here. Local storage, local first applications has become.

A phenomenon.

Under our, you know, it's like pulling the carpet under your feet. We all assumed, oh, the best thing, best architecture is central data, data lake.

Applications on the cloud.

Right. All of these are assumptions based on yesterday's reality that the highest cost was writing code and maintaining the code. So you wanted to keep it in one place.

OK, now suddenly that carpet is pulled from under our feet.

OK, so DC you you you ask DC, he's like hopping around on one foot with the excitement of this technology. OK, because not only is it interesting for us to be able to create new architecture and deployment architecture.

But it is also extremely important for agent to agent collaboration because agents are basically local to their own processes and how are they going to communicate with other agents if you don't have a way in which to meaningfully synchronize data across local systems.

Systems.

So it's not anymore the trivial old technology of local first. It has a new implication in today's technology and we are very, very excited to be able to present that perspective to you. The last is the governance trap. We talked about this.

And you know, if you generate code fast, if you generate automation fast, you risk that it may be doing the wrong things and you get more technical debt faster. So we have a few sessions. Malakshmi, I mentioned her before. She's heading our architecture value board and process value board and she's saying how do I need to reinvent myself?

And our whole governance process so that we are able to match the speed of AI, right. So she's going to cover that. We are also fortunate to partner with a platform called CAST. They are going to also be demonstrating their solution along with Mahalakshmi as well as in the demo booth.

Outside and basically cast is accelerating 1 aspect of semantic engineering, which is code analysis.

We know that code is the single source of truth for all legacy applications. We have used it in Asimo, we have used it in Breeze to be able to extract meaning from existing code. But when it comes to millions of lines of code, we need a more industry standard solution like CAST and we are very, very happy to partner with CAST to be able to.

Club the kind of work that we have done as part of our semantic engineering work and using CAST to be able to add those capabilities and add scalability to that. So she's also going to cover how using a platform like CAST will also help us address the.

Acceleration of the governance process.

We are going to cover Venu has presented last year as well as how do you do automation of QA with AI and we have made a lot of progress there, one of the most important things we mentioned.

Testing.

The most important thing about automated code is you don't have the time to test it the conventional way.

So now you need a new definition of what do you mean by acceptance tests? They are no more UAT. There's no user, right? Who's going to write? Who's going to test whether your code is accepted or not? So unless you.

As part of your requirements, are able to create acceptance tests not after it the code is written, but before the code is written and is not new. Test driven development already existed. How many of our teams are doing TDD 0?

It's just not worth doing it when you're doing it manually. Just unnecessary extra work for human developers and human QA engineers to spend time because the BA doesn't know how to do TDD product owner.

Doesn't know how to do TDD. Who's going to write the acceptance test? If the acceptance test is going to be written by the developer, it's pointless. He doesn't know. He's just going to do what he's doing in the QA. He's just I wrote the code based on what I thought was right.

And the QA will test what developer said was right and you're going to get whatever was the interpretation of what the developer thought was the original requirement. So unless acceptance tests are owned by the product owner, TDD is useless and we never had a situation with product owners were able to write.

Acceptance days. Well, that's possible now because they don't have to manually do it.

OK, we can automate the process of acceptance test and that is going to make a huge difference on governance to make sure that what you get is not junk. So Venu is going to be presenting that.

Nitin and Shikhar, as part of a five layer architecture, are also going to cover governance as part of the last layer of their architecture. I'm not going to give away some of the interesting stuff that we're going to present, but I just want to tell you that that's something that we're going to cover and Mahesh.

Who runs our Security Center of Excellence is also going to be talking about, just like Maha is going to talk about how architecture, value board and the governance process of technology governance has to accelerate. We also need to be worried about GRC.

Right. How do we take care of risks while we are doing this transformation? How do you make sure that we are not unnecessarily exposing ourselves to kind of compliance risks or security risks? So how do we need to upgrade our GRC process to make sure it is no more the?

Corner office, which we go to when a red flag hits you, right? You have to do it proactively. And if you do it proactively, you have to scale up. How do you scale that up? We never paid enough attention.

To GRC unless we were forced to. So how do we proactively make sure that without necessarily spending too much money, we are still able to scale? So Mahesh is going to present some other perspective on that.

I mentioned before that all of this time we have been talking about how do we take care of the risks, OK. But like I mentioned earlier, there are opportunities, there are new opportunities to scale up.

And to expand the scope of what we are doing. So we are equally excited to present three different frontiers that we are very excited by. The 1st is what I talked about before in terms of software as a.

Specification as a product where you actually address the long tail of your customers. We, you know we we talk about small customers with small revenue per.

Per user as they can't afford us. It's focus on the enterprise, the large customers and who is going to disrupt your business. The AI natives are going to come and address that bottom end of your market, OK.

They're going to create the simpler products from scratch using AI, using a fraction

of the cost that it costs you to build your products today, and they're going to eat your lunch from the bottom, right? So that's the.

How do we make sure that we don't fall prey to that kind of risk? OK, is something that DC is going to cover in terms of the long tail of software. The second one is, I think Jayavant covered this last year brilliantly.

He said technology for the first time is going to allow us to automate. Those processes were never considered to be part of technology scope. Customer support automation was always considered to be oh, you can put ServiceNow and get take care of it.

That's not enough. Now you can get rid of, you know, transform your entire customer service process. You can you can take care of things which were done traditionally as repeated, repeatable processes done by human beings because they were decisions, context, sensitive decisions.

To be made for every instance.

It's not scalable because it is not uniform. You can't build a rule for it. You need to take a decision. I need a human being. First time we have technology which can make decisions as long as we build meaningful contextual models. Now you can automate those processes. That means we need to start looking at areas which were never considered to be part of your.

Your IT budget before, OK, if we are worried about how to reduce costs of IT in areas where you're already spending, it doesn't mean your budgets are going to reduce. It just means that you are expected to do much more than you ever were expected to do before. And so the frontiers of what is the scope of work for technology.

Is going to drastically change, not just minute. OK. And the third frontier, which we are still, I think a little bit early for and none of the current technologies, if you've heard Yann Lecun's new.

Business that he's set up his world models, he's basically saying.

You know, he he makes a very, very compelling argument that LLMS have been trained on like trillions and trillions of documents on the net. OK, language and maybe images which are converted into some kind of tokens.

He says a three-year old child through the senses, through its visual and hearing and touch senses, gets information equivalent to 30 trillion.

Bytes of information in just three years.

So you can imagine the amount of contextual information that exists in human beings and in their skulls. You may think it's very trivial because what we produce

from the knowledge that we have.

Is what has been used for training these models so it knows what you produced. It doesn't know what you had in your head OK and unless you have models which can start learning to say when I push the glass.

Us beyond a certain level, it's going to fall and break.

Unless it knows how to predict the outcomes, predict the outcomes, not you tell the outcome and it knows what to do.

That's a whole new ball game and these models are just about emerging now, OK.

And we are very excited by the physical models. In a small way, we have tried to address some of this. So three things we were talking, we already talked about the long tail of software. So that is one topic.

Sumeet is going to be talking about Sumeet's presentation is fabulous.

He's going to divert some of the secrets of how he's going to build the next architecture for expanding the scope of what software can do into human driven processes. And he's built a fascinating model with a skill based model and how do you build that and so we are going to hear from Sumeeth about.

About that and what we have done in our advanced technology group has been playing around with an idea which is.

VR was always a sort of technology that happened and you know, 3D was maybe interesting for games. We're saying, hang on, why was it so difficult to do 3D? It's because you spent hours building the 3D models.

OK, that is why it was difficult. But what if we can build 3D models on the fly?

Now what can you do with it?

And so we are question, we are answering that question or exploring what you can do with that question by looking at one of the most complex things that we do in terms of user interface, which is data analytics. OK, the kind of reporting that we do on dashboarding we do today in data analytics.

Would say is pathetic.

The graphs, which we were doing like, you know, 50 years ago, we still have the same graphs. We still have the same analysis. We are saying, oh, now you can do conversational graphs. The end of it, you're still giving graphs. You have no way to figure out that when I click on this dashboard, in my head, I'm going to make a relationship between what I clicked and what I'm going to see next.

How are you going to use 3D to be able to solve this problem? It's still very, very early, but very exciting and you'll get to play around with it because you can wear a

VR headset and you can explore how analytics will change with that.

So very exciting. So brings us back to square one, saying we covered the risks, we covered the opportunities. Now what do we need to do as an engineer?

OK, so we talked about, yes, at a high level we need to stop writing code and we need to do all of this great.

But my question is, and I presented this last year as well, we always patched up to the challenge. This is not the first time that the engineer has to change his role or her role, right? We have gone through so many iterations we.

You know, my father used to work in IBM, OK? And I as a kid walked into the office there and I saw this room full of machines and they were eight MB RAM.

In one room full of machines. OK, from there we have come to today where this device sitting in my pocket is like, you know, has no comparison in my own lifetime from where I started and you know, first code I wrote was on deck 10.

And you know, it was in Fortran. And from there we have come to where we are today, where I can generate code from cloud code if I know exactly what to ask it. Huge transformation. So we have always changed, right? It's not like everybody predicted, oh, now compilers came. No, now.

Low code platforms. You don't need to write UI anymore. All of these predictions happened. We changed.

Granted, this change is bigger than ever before.

Granted, but the opportunity is sitting in front of us and I think if you are truly looking at what you actually do versus what you think you do as an engineer, this is going to be the most exciting part of your career.

OK. And I think this is a huge opportunity for us to be able to leverage this. And in Axion, you know, we already started this journey a few years ago. We are not only brainwashing, but also retraining our people on how do you?

Changed from becoming a coder to a semantic engineer. We have been doing training courses. We have been experimenting with the technologies, experiment methodologies. We're very excited to partner with some customers who have helped us on this journey. What we are looking for this year.

Is that our clients need to match the pace.

We expect that we want everyone to be as excited as us and not be afraid by the kind of statements that we hear in the market because we know what is possible.

And what is not possible and how to make it work. And we are showing you this year in the summit that actual results can be achieved if you do it the right way. So my.

Hope is after this summit, it's not merely theory. We are actually having meaningful outcomes that we have achieved and we want to be able to partner with you. Yes, we may not have figured everything to the dot. We still have to work together as partners and make things work with you.

OK, but let us not get stuck by the fear.

Let's move forward with with with clear idea about what things can be done and what is what is not possible and what is possible and how do we make it work together. That is our imploration.

O.

Basically we just spent this session on the harder problems as a semantic engineer, not the I I didn't have any session. We don't have any session on how to write code. We we used to do that till a few years ago on how do you build architectures for. Microservices and how do you take care of PW ES and SW? None of those topics are there. And like Inesh said last year, almost everything was about this new technology and he was he was saying, are you serious? Is going to be actually implemented and sure enough.

2076 summit, we're not talking about theory, we're talking about actual results that we have got during this year and we want to share it with you to get your feedback, get your participation and collaboration. Everyone, both Axion employees as well as many of our Axion employees are today.

For all practical purposes, working within the silo of our customer engagements, we cannot force them to get out of the kind of constraints that customers have put on those engagements and say now magically transform yourself into semantic engineers.

This is not a black box engagement model. This is a white box engagement model. You have full visibility and you have full control as clients on what our teams do and we cannot transform ourselves till we work with you.

So it's very, very crucial that we need our customer support to be able to make this journey as exciting as we hope it's going to be for us.

So.

Anthropic was right. AI will write most of the code. But Lacun, who said that's all
*****, is also right. Engineering won't disappear. We're going to change.

So that's about it. What I'm going to leave you with is the actual schedule. We have a packed schedule. This is there in your app, but I'm going to request that this schedule be published and also displayed on the screen.

Every time you come in. So we have divided this into four groups, day two, first half, day two, second-half, day three, first half and day three, second-half. It's a packed schedule. You're going to get tired.

You're going to be jet lagged, many of you.

But please bear with us. We are very excited to present all of these topics. All the speakers have worked hard beyond what their normal job is. Please give them a good hearing and hope you'll get something out of this summit.

and are as excited by this as we are. Thank you.

Hello. OK, I don't know where Praveen is master of ceremonies, but.

Finally go out and use the loo if you want to and dinner is also served. So thank you everyone for patiently listening to us today and I hope you have the same level of patience tomorrow and day after.

Thank you so much.

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